

Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) are documented guidelines and instructions that an organization or an individual follows to perform a task of a process in a consistent and standardized manner.

Why use SOP?

1. **Consistency:** SOP ensures tasks are performed the same way every time.
2. **Efficiency:** SOP saves time, resources, and reduces errors.
3. **Training Tool:** SOP helps new employee understand their job functions.
4. **Compliance and Safety:** SOP adheres to regulations and ensures safety.
5. **Set-up the project for success:** SOP provide a common vision for how projects are to be executed.

Phases to create an SOP

1. The Initiation Phase
2. The Planning Phase
3. The Development Phase
4. The Implementation Phase

What to include?

- Title
- Scope
- Users
- Definitions
- Roles and Responsibilities
- Procedure Steps
- Revision History
- Appendices

SOPs should be living documents, updated regularly to ensure ongoing efficiency, consistency, and regulatory compliance.

SOP Format

- Written Procedures
- Flowcharts or Diagrams
- Checklists
- Videos
- Interactive E-Learning Modules
- Infographics

The Initiation Phase



The Lippitt-Knoster Model for Managing Complex Change

Vision +	Consensus +	Skills +	Motivations +	Resources +	Action Plan =	Success
X	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	Confusion
✓	X	✓	✓	✓	✓	Sabotage
✓	✓	X	✓	✓	✓	Anxiety
✓	✓	✓	X	✓	✓	Resistance
✓	✓	✓	✓	X	✓	Frustration
✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	X	False Starts

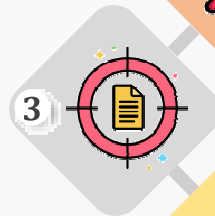
The Planning Phase

Create SOP Log



Define the Scope

What is the goal of the SOP?
Why is the process important?
When the SOP is to be used?
Where the SOP is to be used?

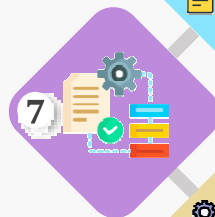
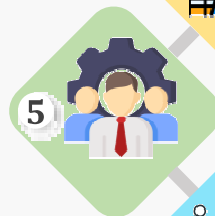


Identify necessary Resources

Who to involve? (stakeholders)
What information is available?

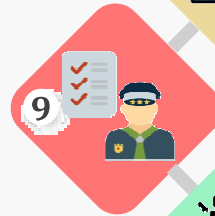
Develop the Procedure

How to complete a task?
What visuals and information to include?



Deploy & Enforce

How to train?
Who will conduct the training?
How to enforce?



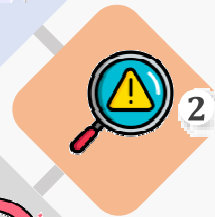
Planning Tools

What planning tools should we use?



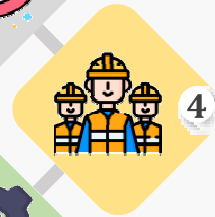
Identify the Need

Which processes need an SOP?



Identify the Audience

Who will be using the SOP?



Plan for Input Collection

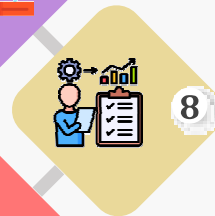
How to gather information?
How to assign roles and responsibilities?



Accountability Plan

Will there be a feedback mechanism? Regular reviews?

How to measure the SOP's success?



Feedback & Testing

How to gather feedback on the draft SOP?
How to test the SOP?



The Development Phase



The Implementation Phase

Train SOP users

Different training methods
Addressing misunderstanding
Clarifying SOP details

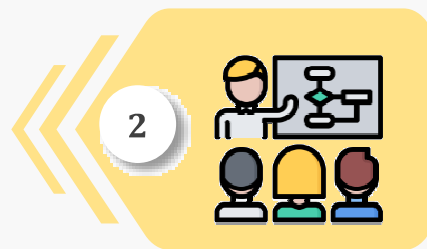


Deploy the SOP

Communicate:

- Why SOP matters
- What's expected from users
- SOP location
- Measurement of SOP's success
- Emphasis on continuous improvement

Answer questions



Execute accountability plan

Communicate the roles and responsibilities formally
Setting up reminders for SOP review

Launch, promote, monitor, and respond to feedback
Track metrics and report them to stakeholders

